Week 4 · Aug 3–9 · BUILD (🟡 DELOAD) — "Ship the strategy memo, breathe"

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> 🟡 **DELOAD WEEK.** Load is intentionally ~40% lighter this week for exam crunch. This is by design, not falling behind. Skills are dialed down to a single light session; the project is strategy-only (no heavy tech). Protect your exam time first — everything here fits *around* it.

🎯 **This week's mission:** Finish and publish the **Costco strategy memo** (project 2 of 10 ✅) — a low-tech, high-insight win that shows off your real edge — while keeping the exam week calm.

Day-by-day

Day	Status	What to do
Mon	🎓 Class 3–9pm	*Light only.* Read *The Goal* Ch 1 (30 min) **or** send 1 networking DM before class. That's it — rest for class.
Tue	✅ Free (cap 3–4 hrs, keep it light)	**#4 Costco memo** — build the core analysis: inventory-turn comparison vs. a competitor, pull the 2–3 numbers that carry the argument. Strategy + light Excel only.
Wed	🎓 Class 6–9pm	2 hr block before class: **SQL window functions intro** (mode.com, ~1 session). This is the *only* new skill this week — one pass, understand it, move on.
Thu	✅ Free (cap 3–4 hrs)	**#4 Costco memo** — write the **Recommendation** (your insight layer — the whole point) + "What I'd do next." Then **coffee chat #1**.
Fri	✅ Free	**Finish + PUBLISH the Costco memo** to GitHub + Notion (2/10 ✅). Attend **1 networking event** (lighter is fine) or **2nd chat**. Optional light LinkedIn share if energy allows.
Sat	🎓 Class 9–6 · night OFF 🔒	No work after class. Recharge.
Sun	✅ Free	**Consulting: 1 practice case with a classmate** (low-stakes, fun). *The Goal* Ch 2–3 if fresh. Exam/assignment buffer. **Weekly review (15 min).**

📚 Where to study / resources this week

- **SQL (light):** window functions intro — mode.com/sql-tutorial. One session only. Detail → ../01-skills.md.
- **Project #4 Costco memo:** strategy teardown, minimal data — format is Problem → Approach → Finding → Recommendation → Next. See ../02-projects.md.
- **Book:** *The Goal* Ch 1–3 → ../04-reading-list.md.
- **Consulting fit-test:** practice case guide → ../05-consulting.md.
- **Networking templates & tracker:** ../03-networking.md.

✅ Done by Sunday

- ☐ **Costco strategy memo finished + published** (GitHub + Notion) — project 2 of 10 ✅
- ☐ Memo ends in a clear **Recommendation** (your strategy layer, with a number)
- ☐ SQL window functions — 1 intro session done
- ☐ *The Goal* Ch 1–3 read
- ☐ 1 practice case with a classmate done
- ☐ 2 coffee chats + 1 event (lighter OK)
- ☐ Weekly review — **On pace despite the crunch?**

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